Q+A

Doctor's Orders

DR SHRIRAM NENE'S NEW BOOK, *21 DAYS TO GOOD HEALTH*, CHARTS OUT A PRACTICAL, EVIDENCE-BASED PROGRAMME TO REBOOT YOUR HEALTH



Q. What compelled you to write *21 Days to Good Health*?

Having spent nearly two decades practising cardiothoracic and vascular surgery in the US, I've had the privilege of witnessing the extraordinary power of modern medicine. But one realisation stayed with me: so much of the disease I was treating had been developing silently over decades, and much of it could potentially have been prevented. We've become incredibly good at treating illness, but we haven't been nearly as successful at creating a culture of wellness. That was the inspiration.

They say it takes 21 days to form a habit. Is that why you chose this title?

Interestingly, recent research suggests that habits often take considerably longer to become automatic. So why 21 days? Because 21 days is not a magic number for forming a permanent habit, but it is a powerful starting point for meaningful change.

What was the most surprising thing you discovered about health while researching the book?

As a surgeon, I was trained to focus on anatomy, physiology, disease and treatment. But the research on longevity reveals that the quality of our relationships and our sense of belonging are remarkably important predictors of long-term well-being.

How do you incorporate the principles outlined in your book into your own life and marriage with Madhuri Dixit?

Spending quality time with Madhuri, our children, family and friends is an essential part of my well-being. I believe that as physicians, we need to practise what we preach. Movement is non-negotiable. I also prioritise sleep and recovery. Stress management and human connection are equally important.

—with Amit Dixit